

The Entrepreneur



Veronica Motloutsi is a distinguished leader in digital transformation, recognized for her visionary impact across South Africa and the African continent. With over 25 years of experience in ICT, her career spans multiple sectors, including Energy, Health, Mining, Retail, Financial Services, and Logistics. She has established herself as a trailblazer in the dynamic world of digital innovation.

Veronica is the Founder and CEO of SmartDigital Solution, a 100% Black female-owned digital transformation company. SmartDigital Solution is strategically positioned to harness the opportunities of the Fourth Industrial Revolution, helping both private and public sector clients lead in digital transformation.

Committed to the African vision, SmartDigital Solution's mission is to empower clients to achieve their digital goals and shape industry standards. The company leverages cutting-edge technologies such as Artificial Intelligence, the Internet of Things, and Big Data to transform and optimize operations across Southern Africa.

Additionally, through partnerships like the one with the Commonwealth, SmartDigital Solution works to capacitate and empower women across the continent in Digital Infrastructure, digital trade, Artificial Intelligence, and other transformative technologies.

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Worksheet Zero:

The Entrepreneur's Journey

Worksheet 0

Summarise the entrepreneur's journey.



Upbringing, Education, and Career



Enterprising Efforts and Interests



Entrepreneurial Choices and Decisions



Pivotal Moment



Standout Idea



Opportunity Optimization



Current State



Balancing Life



The dilemma

Worksheet One:

Upbringing, Education & Career

Worksheet 1

Provide biographical information about the entrepreneur, including upbringing, education, career trajectory, and journey into entrepreneurship.

UPBRINGING...

EDUCATION...

CAREER...





Worksheet Two:

Entrepreneurial Characteristics and Traits

Worksheet 2

Identify, analyse, and write in the circle the entrepreneurial characteristics and traits possessed by Veronica.

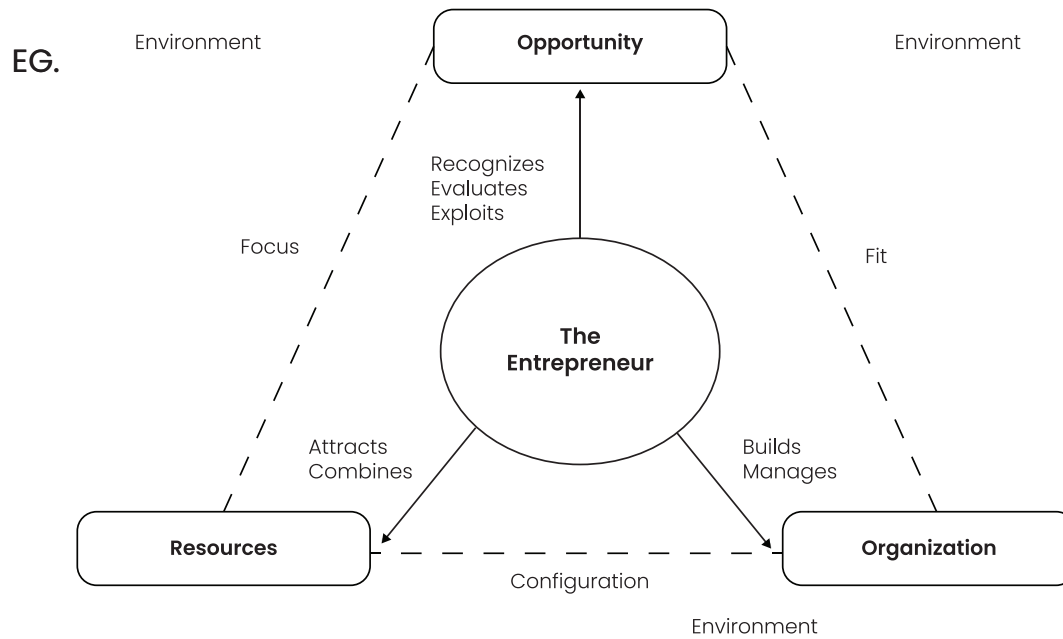


Worksheet Three:

The Entrepreneurship Process

Worksheet 3

Analyse how Veronica recognised opportunities, leveraged resources, and formed an organisation and navigating the environment through the entrepreneurial process.



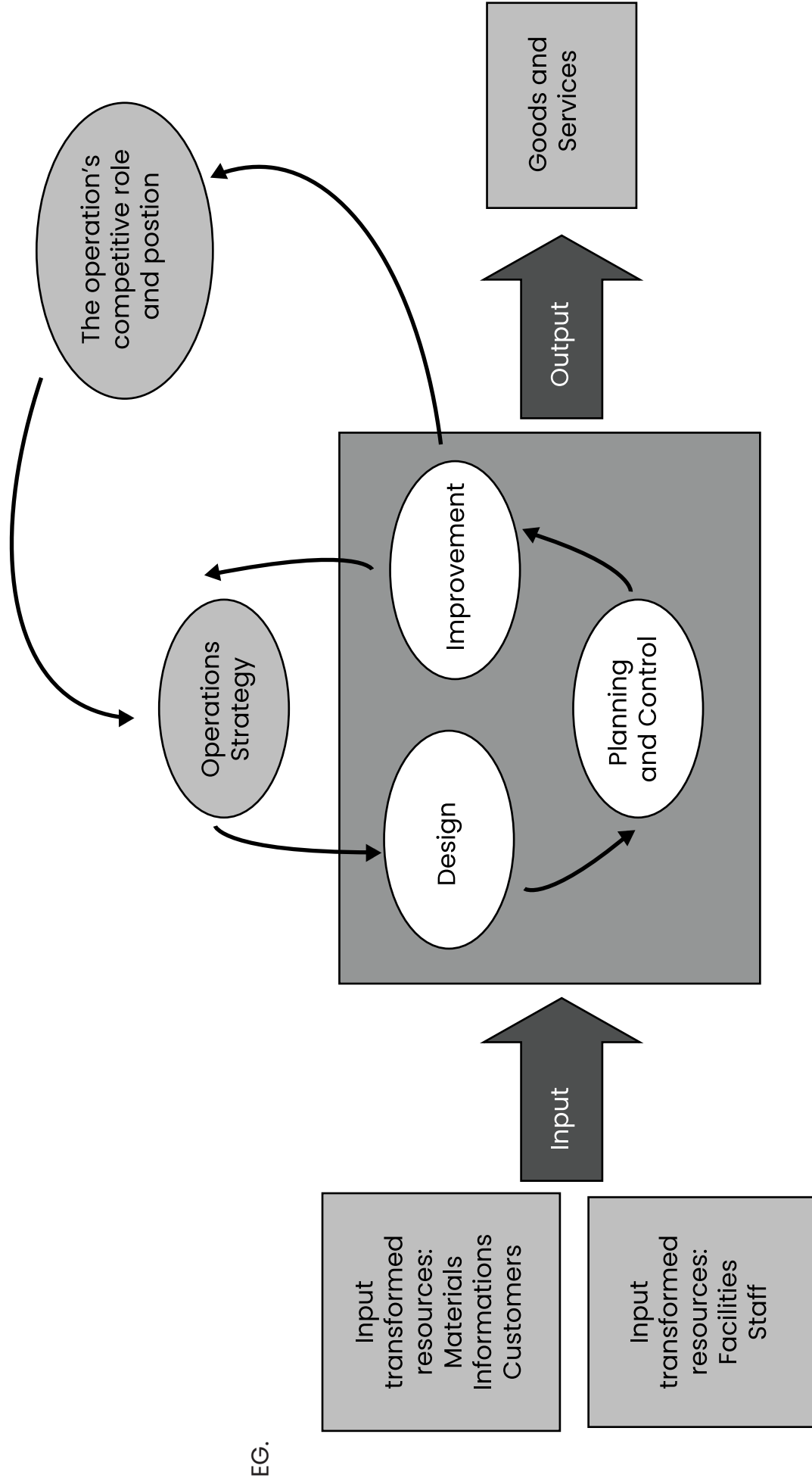
Worksheet Four:

Unpacking SmartDigital Solutions Business Model

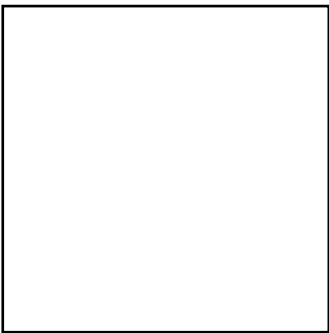
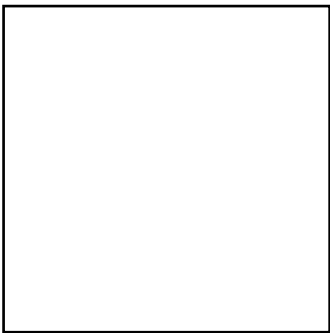
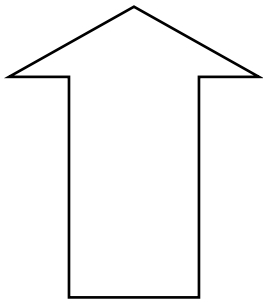
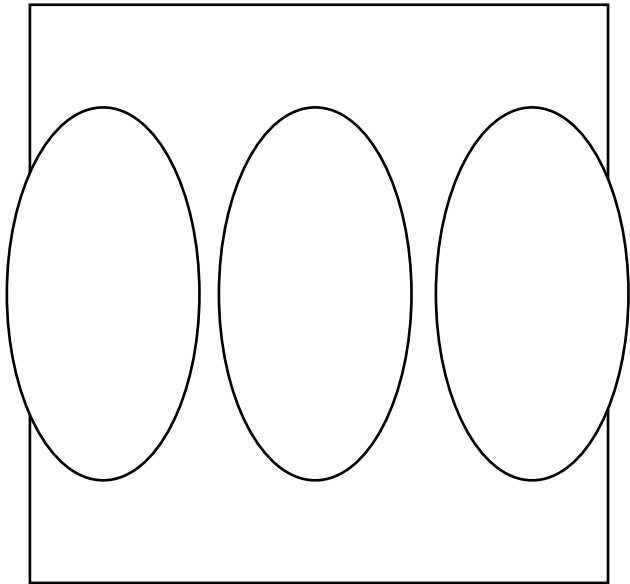
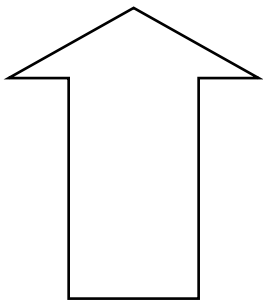
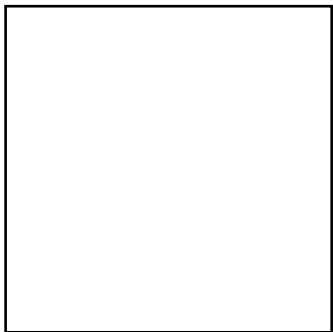
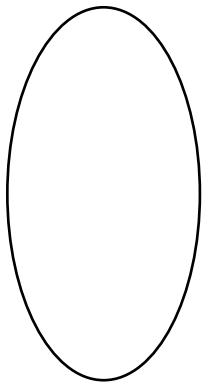
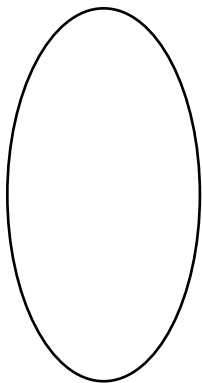
Worksheet 4.1

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Worksheet 4.2 Operations Process



Worksheet 4.2 Complete the Operation Process



Worksheet 4.3 Business Model Canvas

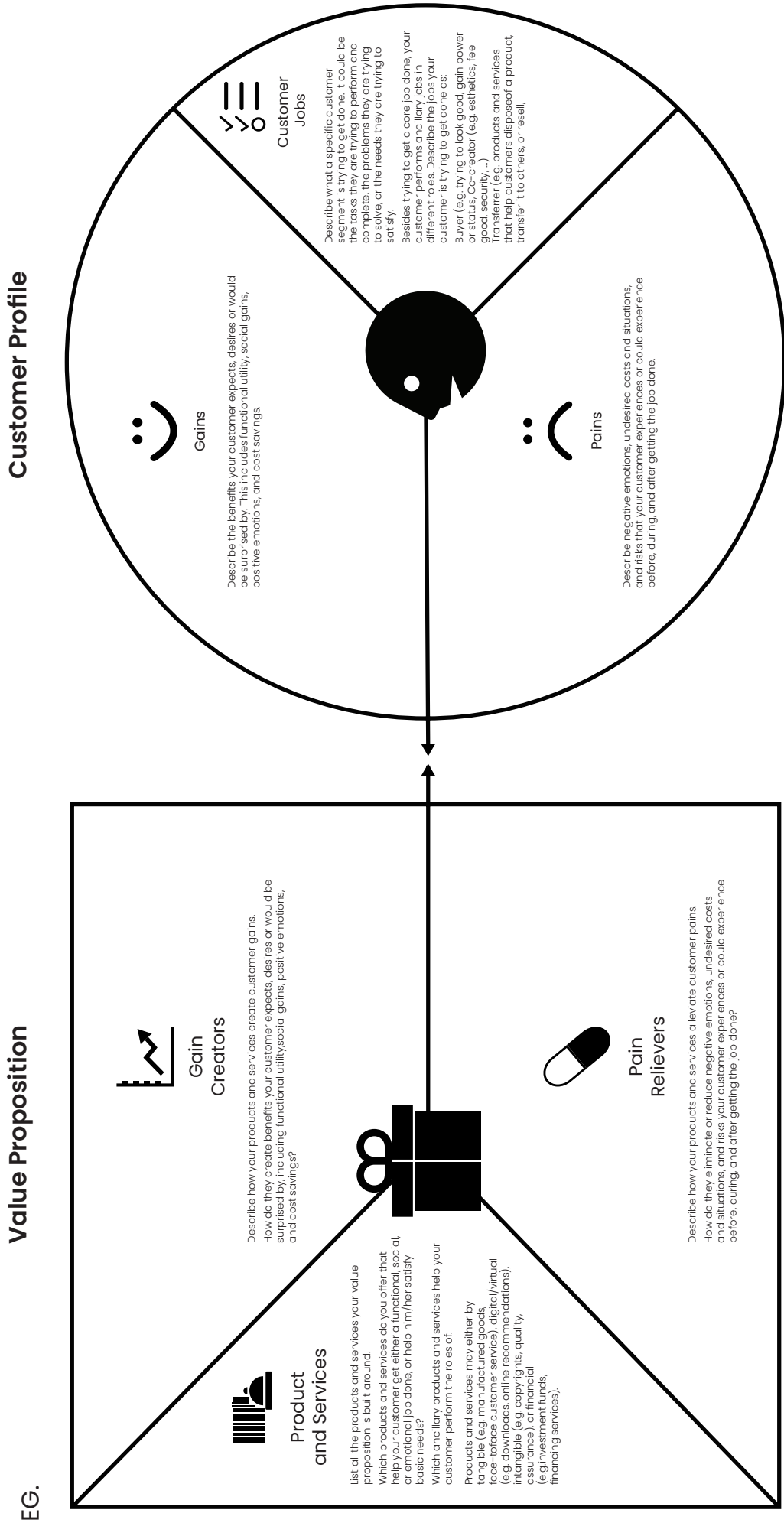
KEY PARTNERS  Who are our Key Partners? Who are our Key Suppliers? Which Key Resources are we acquiring from partners? Which Key Activities do partners perform?	KEY ACTIVITIES  What Key Activities do our Value Propositions require? Our Distribution Channels? Customer Relationships? Revenue streams?	VALUE PROPOSITIONS  What value do we deliver to the customer? Which one of our customer's problems are we helping to solve? What bundles of products and services are we offering to each Customer Segment? Which customer needs are we satisfying?	CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS What type of relationship does each of our Customer Segments expect us to establish and maintain with them? Which ones have we established? How are they integrated with the rest of our business model? How costly are they? CHANNELS  Through which Channels do our Customer Segments want to be reached? How are we reaching them now? How are our Channels integrated? Which ones work best? Which ones are most cost-efficient? How are we integrating them with customer routines?	CUSTOMER SEGMENTS  For whom are we creating value? Who are our most important customers?
COST STRUCTURE What are the most important costs inherent in our business model? Which Key Resources are most expensive? Which Key Activities are most expensive?			REVENUE STREAMS  For what value are our customers really willing to pay? For what do they currently pay? How are they currently paying? How would they prefer to pay? How much does each Revenue Stream contribute to overall revenues?	

Worksheet 4.3 Complete the Business Model Canvas

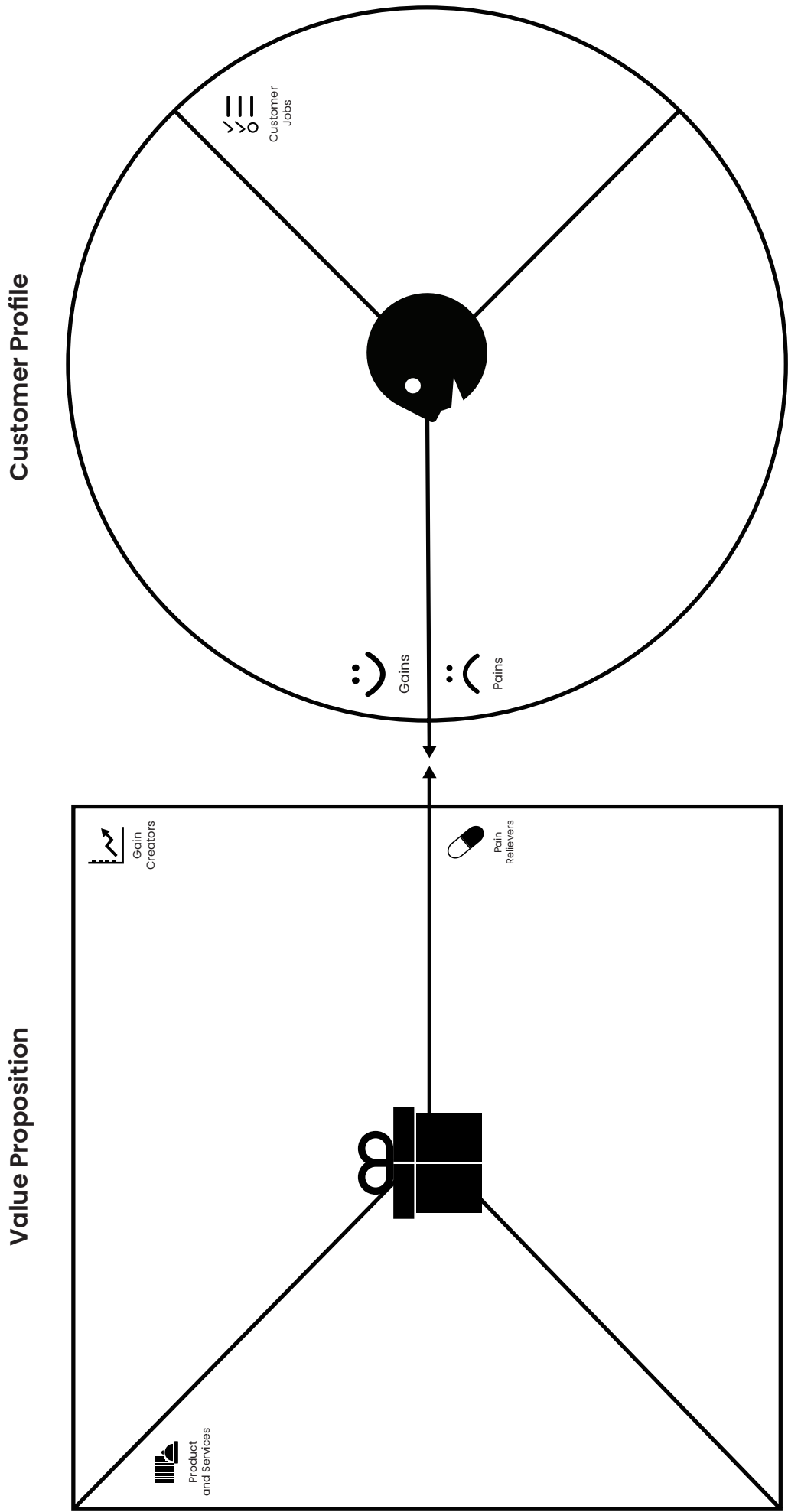
KEY PARTNERS 	KEY ACTIVITIES 	VALUE PROPOSITIONS 		CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS	CUSTOMER SEGMENTS 
KEY RESOURCES 	CHANNELS 	REVENUE STREAMS 			
		COST STRUCTURE 			



Worksheet 4.4 Value Proposition Canvas



Worksheet 4.4 Complete Value Proposition Canvas



Value Proposition

Product and Services

[illegible]

Gain Creators

[illegible]

Pain Relievers

[illegible]

Customer Profile

Gains

[illegible]

Customer Jobs

[illegible]

Pains

[illegible]

Worksheet Five:

The Entrepreneurial Profile

Worksheet 5

Analyse SmartDigital Solutions entrepreneurial capabilities, qualities, and style.
Complete the tree map below.

Remember: capabilities (the power or ability to do something), qualities (a distinctive characteristic possessed by someone), and style (a leader's characteristic behaviours when directing and motivating people).

Capabilities	Qualities	Style



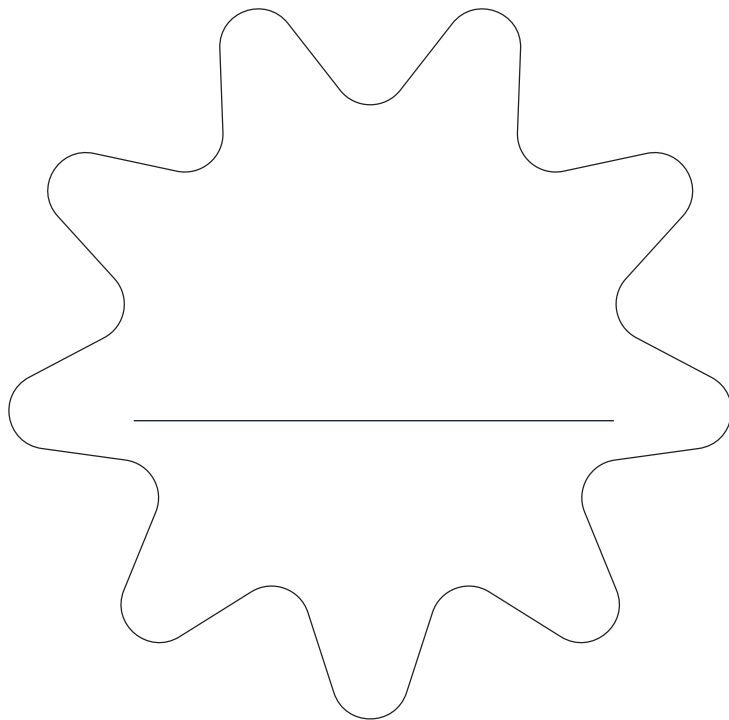
Worksheet Six:

The Entrepreneur's Facts

Worksheet 6

Write down interesting facts that you have learnt about Veronica.

Find the word that best describes Veronica



Source and write a note worthy quote by Veronica that resonates the most.

Veronica Motloutsi Informed Entrepreneurship Workbook



Worksheet Seven:

Entrepreneurial Lessons

Worksheet 7

Reflect on the lessons learned from Veronica’s entrepreneurial journey. List and explain the entrepreneurial lessons you have learned or the ones that resonate the most with you.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

Worksheet Eight:

Life Lessons

Worksheet 8

Reflect on the broader life lessons learned from Veronica's journey. List and reason about the life lessons by categorising them as things you have learned, things you will walk away with, new things you didn't know about, and those that you will act on.

I learnt that... _____

I learnt that... _____

I take away... _____

I take away... _____

I take away... _____

I did not know that... _____

I will Implement... _____



The background is a dark navy blue. On the left side, there is a large, light blue-grey semi-circle. Inside this semi-circle is a smaller, dark navy blue circle. At the bottom left, a dark navy blue triangle points upwards and to the right, partially overlapping the semi-circle.

Worksheet Nine:

Take Action

1



Veronica Motloutsi Informed Entrepreneurship Workbook



Worksheet Ten:

Interview an Entrepreneur

Worksheet 10

Identify, contact, and interview the entrepreneur; reflect on the entrepreneur engagement experience; and share lessons, recommendations, and feedback.

Worksheet 10.1

In this section, your task is to interview a entrepreneur in your neighbourhood and explore their understanding of entrepreneurship. Through this interview, you will gain insights into the challenges and opportunities that come with starting and running a business.

Step 1:

Identify an entrepreneur in your neighbourhood whom you would like to interview. You can use various resources such as social media, local business directories, or word of mouth to find them.

Step 2:

Contact the entrepreneur and request an interview. You can do this via email, phone call, or in-person visit. Explain the purpose of the interview, the time required, and the expected outcomes.

Step 3:

Prepare a set of questions for the interview. This will help you to focus the conversation and ensure that you cover all the essential aspects of entrepreneurship. Some potential questions might include:

- What inspired you to start your business?
- What are some of the biggest challenges you faced when starting your business?
- How did you overcome these challenges?
- What has been your most successful business venture so far, and why?
- What advice would you give to someone who wants to start their own business?

Step 4:

Conduct the interview. This can be done in-person, over the phone, or via video conferencing. Make sure to record the conversation with the entrepreneur's permission.

Step 5:

Analyze the data collected during the interview. This can be done by reviewing the recording, taking notes, and summarizing the key findings.

Step 6:

Reflect on the insights gained from the interview. This can be done individually or as a group. Consider the challenges and opportunities faced by entrepreneurs and how they impact the local economy.

Step 7:

Write a report summarizing the interview and your reflections. This can be done in the form of a written essay, a presentation, or a video. Make sure to include key takeaways from the interview and any recommendations for aspiring entrepreneurs.

Notes

Step 1: The Entrepreneur

[illegible]

Step 2: The Engagement

[illegible]

Step 3: The Questions

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. On the left side, there is a vertical margin line, creating a narrow left margin. The paper appears to be from a notebook or a standard ruled document.

Notes

Step 4: Salient Facts

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Step 5: Key Findings

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Step 6: The Reflection

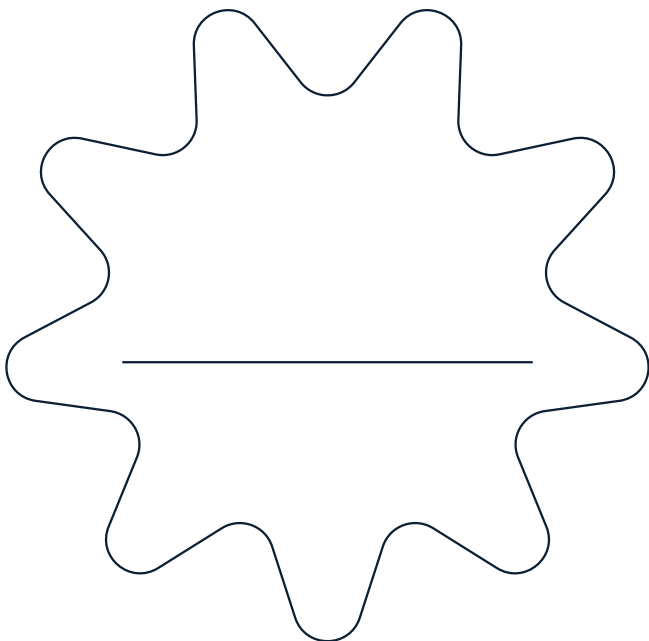
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Notes

Step 7: The Report (Presentation, Podcast, Blog, Newspaper Article...)

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

One word that describes the entrepreneur



Worksheet 10.2

Make use of the Entrepreneurship Journey (Worksheet 0) and the Operations Model (Worksheet 4.1) when interviewing the entrepreneur, this will assist in you in the interview process.

Remember:

- The search for the big idea
- The unique opportunity and exploited it
- Challenges faced
- The Wins
- The Lessons

Operations Model (use. Worksheet 4.2) as a guide as well. A framework has been provided for you (page 33).

Remember:

- Inputs
- Production and Transformation
- Output
- Customer Experience

Staffing:

- How many employees are employed by the entrepreneur?
- What roles do they fill?
- What training is offered or should be offered?
- How is performance managed?

Inventory:

- What inventory is managed, and how is it managed?
- How is the supply chain managed, and how are the supply chain relationships managed?
- What tools or systems will you use to track inventory?

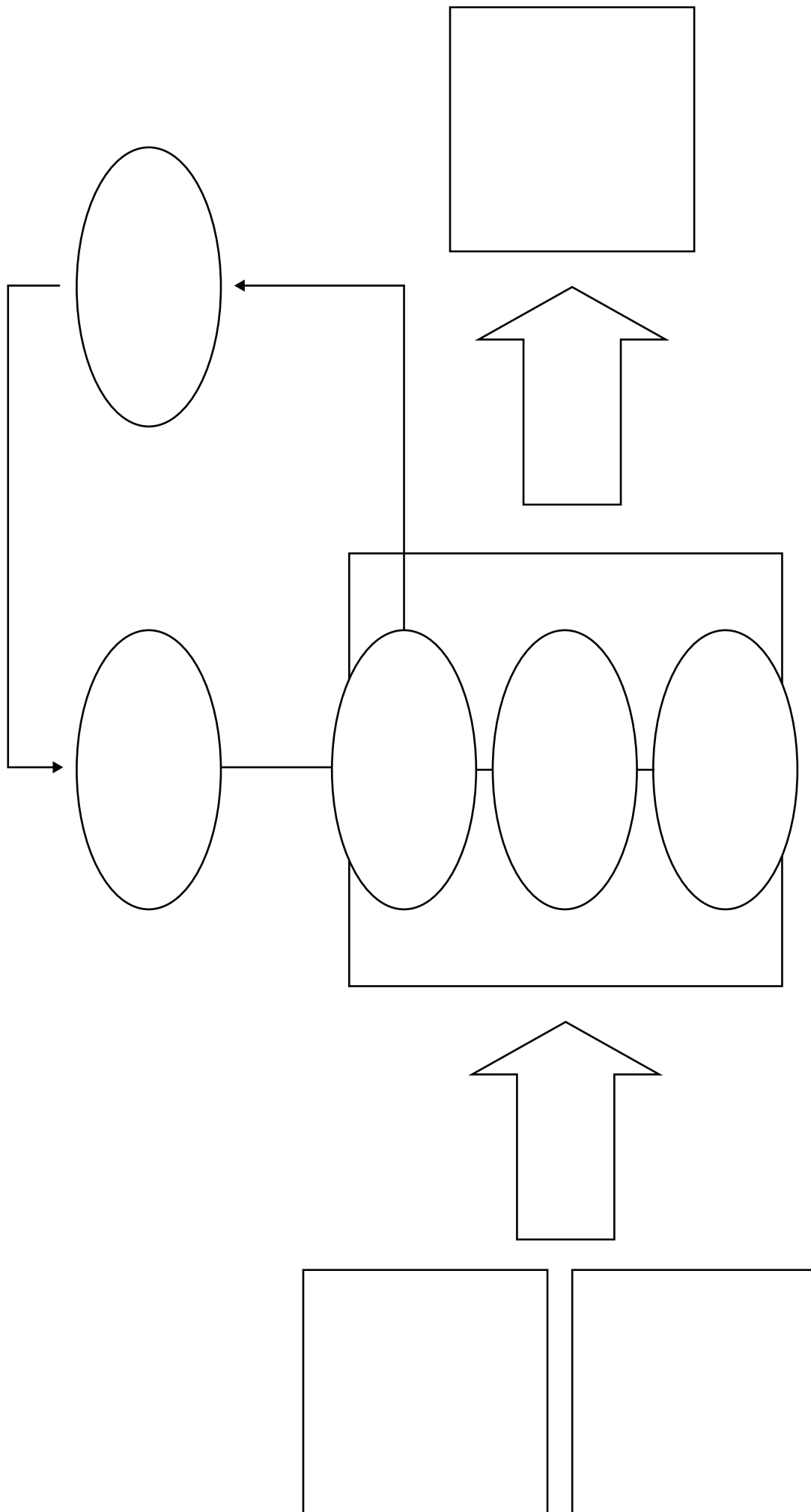
Customer Service:

- What is the customer service philosophy?
- How does the entrepreneur ensure that customers are satisfied?
- How is customer satisfaction measured?
- How does he or his business respond to feedback?

Review the operations plan of the entrepreneur:

- Identify where the current operational plan falls short. What shortfalls did you identify?
- Make recommendations to close the identified gaps. What recommendations did you make?
- How open to feedback was the entrepreneur? How did you determine this?

Worksheet 10.2 Complete the Operation Process



Notes

Gaps

Recommendations

Feedback

The Author



Dr Steven Zwane (BSc Computer Science – University of Zululand, SA; Master of Business Administration & Doctor of Business Administration – Durham University, UK)

Steven Zwane is a highly accomplished entrepreneur and dedicated educator, renowned for his influential role in shaping youth leadership and entrepreneurship in South Africa. As the visionary founder of Youth Leadership and Entrepreneurship Development, Steven has empowered over 20,000 young minds, particularly focusing on Grade 11 students, imparting crucial entrepreneurship skills.

With a wealth of experience spanning two decades, Steven holds a prominent position as an entrepreneurship, operations, and strategy lecturer at the Gordon Institute of Business Science. Recently earning his Doctor of Business Administration from Durham University Business School (UK), he solidifies his commitment to entrepreneurship education.

Steven's research is centered on youth entrepreneurship, education frameworks, and role modeling, particularly for the underprivileged. His doctoral research, "Determining the Influence of Entrepreneurial Intervention on Entrepreneurial Intentions of Youth in South Africa," showcases his dedication to enhancing entrepreneurship training among in-school youth.

Beyond academia, Steven is a devoted volunteer facilitator at YLED for over 20 years, actively contributing to program design and execution. His hands-on involvement adds authenticity to his advocacy for embedding entrepreneurship education in the South African curriculum from an early age.

Through his impactful Entrepreneurship Workbook series, Steven demonstrates practical methods to extend entrepreneurship lessons to the youth. The workbook features entrepreneurs who generously shared their real-world experiences, reinforcing Steven's commitment to making entrepreneurship education an integral part of South Africa's educational framework. His vision is clear: to empower the next generation with the knowledge and mindset for economic independence and job creation.

Dr. Steven Zwane, holding a BSc in Computer Science from the University of Zululand, South Africa, is a distinguished Entrepreneurship Advocate and Educator. With an illustrious academic journey, Steven has earned both a Master of Business Administration and a Doctor of Business Administration from Durham University, UK.



PAPO Communications is a cutting edge management and strategy solutions consulting Business with special focus on human capital development, Business Strategy, Change Management, Technological Solutions and Youth Development services that are targeted at organisations of all sizes.

We use flexible networked models to scale up for the large and complex projects but also to add value on smaller projects as well.

This is reminiscent of our dedication to partnering with clients to deliver measurable and sustainable results with high impact.

We have experience working with local and global organisations in a range of industries. The company is led by Steven Zwane, a 2006/7 Nelson Mandela Scholar, experienced Operations & Technology and Management Consultant and a champion of youth leadership and entrepreneurship development in South Africa – having started and executed a Life Skills and Mentorship Programme for global IT and management consulting firm as well as two of the top four banks in South Africa, he established the youth development focused NGO – YLED.

Papo Communications Aims to provide a wide range of Management Consulting, Strategy Development, Strategy Cascade, Youth Development, Electronic Communication and Technology access services to the community, public and private sector.

For more information:

Steven Zwane
Info@papo.co.za
+27 83 953 6524